ticular, the buses usually need to be *buffered*. Also, *decoding logic* may be used for the memory RAM chips, and, finally, some signals may need to be amplified by *drivers*. These auxiliary circuits will not be described here as they are not relevant to programming. The reader interested in specific assembly and interfacing techniques is referred to book C207 "Microprocessor Interfacing Techniques."

INSIDE A MICROPROCESSOR

The large majority of all microprocessor chips on the market today implement the same architecture. This "standard" architecture will be described here. It is shown in Figure 2.2. The modules of this standard microprocessor will now be detailed, from right to left.

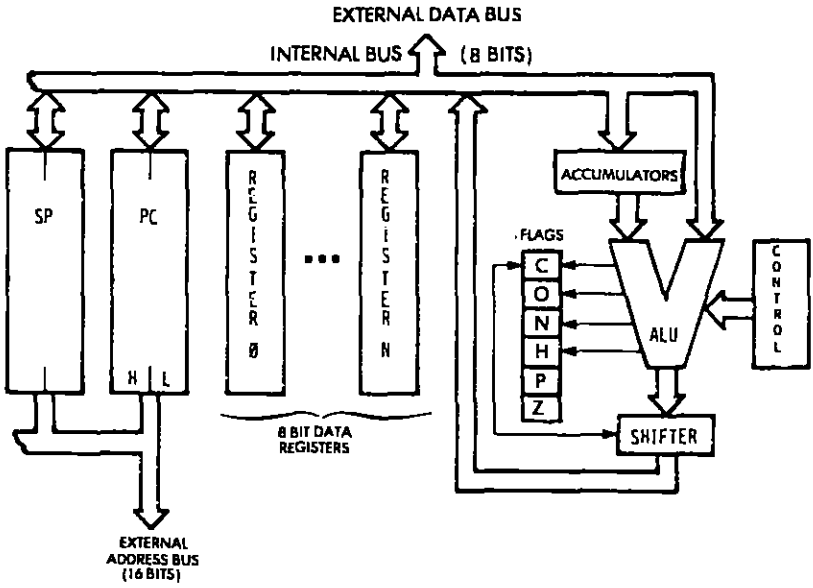


Fig. 2.2: "Standard" Microprocessor Architecture

The *control box* on the right represents the control unit which synchronizes the entire system. Its role will be clarified within the remainder of this chapter.